

Put your app on the internet

Right now your app runs only on your laptop. Today you give it three homes: a database online, a public link anyone in the world can open, and a setup where every change you make goes live on its own.

The trick that makes this easy: you do the clicking, OpenCode does the typing. Everything in a web browser is yours. Everything in the terminal is OpenCode's. You will never type a command you do not understand, and OpenCode will never make you open a settings page. Each step below is tagged so you always know which hat you are wearing.

IN YOUR BROWSER you click and paste

ASK OPENCODE it does the rest

PART 1 • THREE HOMES, ALL FREE

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IN YOUR BROWSER

Make three accounts, in this order

Your app needs three homes, and all three are free. Sign up in this order so they connect cleanly:

- **GitHub** (github.com) — where your code lives.
- **MongoDB Atlas** (mongodb.com/atlas) — where your database lives, online.
- **Vercel** (vercel.com) — where your app runs. Sign up with “**Continue with GitHub**”, so the two are linked from the start.

Will this cost anything? No. GitHub is free, Atlas has a free “M0” database, and Vercel’s “Hobby” plan is free. You will not be asked for a card.

PART 2 • PUT YOUR DATABASE ONLINE (ATLAS)

2

IN YOUR BROWSER

Create a free cluster

In Atlas, create a database and choose the free **M0** tier. Any provider and a nearby region are fine. Give it a minute to start up.

3

IN YOUR BROWSER

Make a database user

Atlas asks you to create a **database user** — a username and password just for your app to connect with. Pick a password with plain letters and numbers (no odd symbols), and write it down. You will paste it in a moment.

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IN YOUR BROWSER

Open it to the world

Go to **Network Access** and add “**Allow access from anywhere**” (`0.0.0.0/0`).

Why this is normal, not reckless: Vercel runs your app on servers whose addresses change all the time, so there is no single one to allow. Your database is still locked behind the username and password from the last step.

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IN YOUR BROWSER

Copy the connection string

Click **Connect** > **Drivers**, and copy the line that starts with `mongodb+srv://`. Make two edits: replace `<password>` with the password you saved, and add your database name just before the `?`.

```
# before
mongodb+srv://appuser:<password>@cluster0.ab12.mongodb.net/?retryWrites=true
# after (password filled in, database name added)
mongodb+srv://appuser:MyPass123@cluster0.ab12.mongodb.net/myapp?retryWrites=true
```

Keep this line safe. It is the key to your database, and you will paste it into Vercel shortly.

PART 3 • SEND YOUR CODE TO GITHUB

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ASK OPENCODE

One sentence, and your code is online

You do not touch git yourself. Just ask:

SAY TO OPENCODE

Create a new GitHub repository for this project and push all my code to it.

OpenCode sets up the repository, saves your code, and uploads it. The first time, it walks you through a quick one-time GitHub login. When it finishes, your code is on github.com.

PART 4 • GO LIVE (VERCEL)

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IN YOUR BROWSER

Import your project

In Vercel, click **Add New** > **Project**. Because you signed up with GitHub, your new repository is right there — click **Import**.

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IN YOUR BROWSER

Hand it the database key

Before deploying, open **Environment Variables** and add one. Name it exactly `MONGODB_URI`, and paste the connection string from Step 5 as the value.

This is how your live app finds its database. The name must be **exactly** `MONGODB_URI`, because that is what your code looks for. This is also why the password never goes into your code or onto GitHub — it lives only here, in Vercel.

Deploy

Click **Deploy** and watch. In a minute or two, Vercel hands you a public link like `your-app.vercel.app`. Open it. That is your app, live, on the internet, for anyone in the world.

PART 5 · THE MAGIC: CHANGE IT LIVE

Push, and it ships itself

Change something in your app, then say:

SAY TO OPENCODE

Push my latest changes.

Vercel notices, rebuilds, and updates your live link on its own. You never run a deploy again — you just push. Professionals call this CI/CD, and you just set it up without knowing you did.

IF SOMETHING IS NOT WORKING

My live app can't reach the database

Two usual causes: Network Access is not `0.0.0.0/0` (Part 2, step 4), or the connection string still has `<password>` in it instead of the real password (and the database name added).

Vercel says the build failed

Copy the red error text from Vercel and paste it to OpenCode. It reads the log, fixes the code, and you push again.

Works on my laptop, not live

Almost always the `MONGODB_URI` variable in Vercel: check it is set, spelled exactly, with the full connection string as its value.

GitHub login has me stuck

Let OpenCode guide the one-time login, or run the step it suggests. After that first time, pushing is automatic.

Anyone Can Build · Day 3 · Ship it. Three homes: **GitHub** holds your code, **Atlas** holds your data, **Vercel** runs your app. You click in the browser; OpenCode drives the terminal.